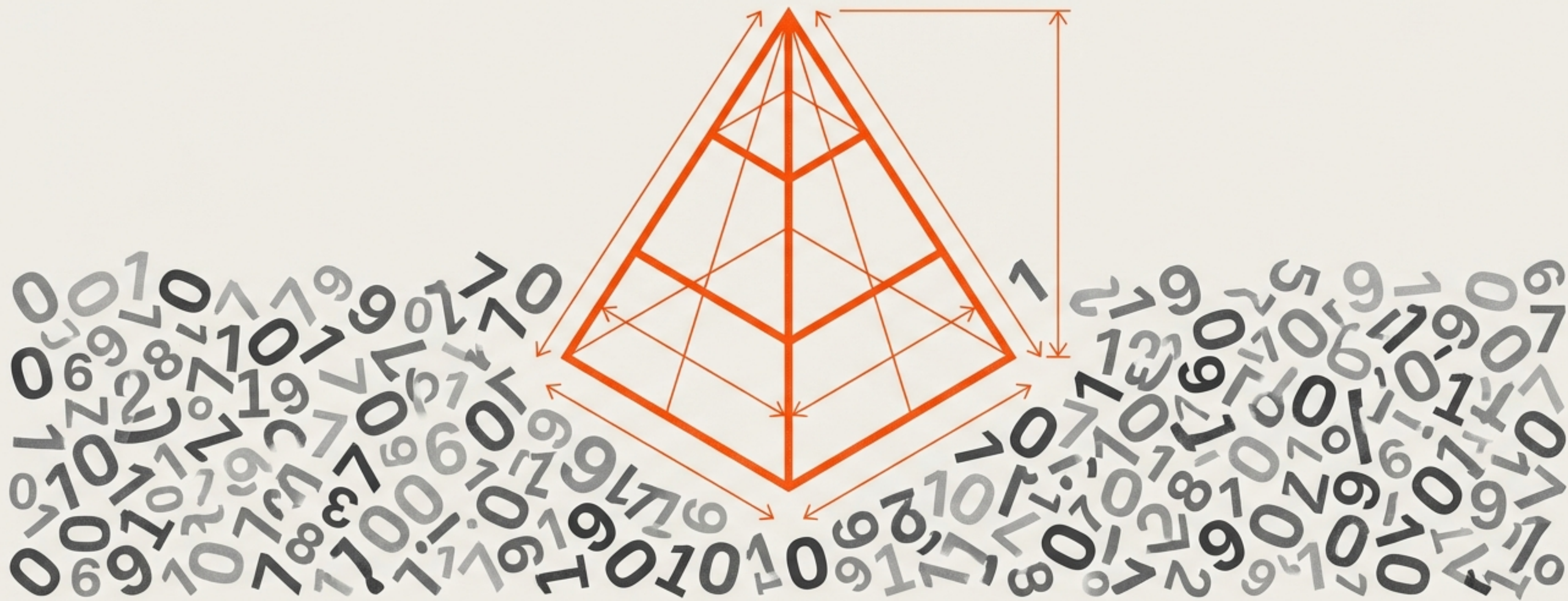


BEYOND THE DASHBOARD: MASTERING BUSINESS METRICS FOR DATA ANALYSTS

How to think, speak, and operate like the top 1% of data professionals



Based on the frameworks by Christine Jiang, Former Data Director

Companies don't just want report builders; they want business partners.

Most job descriptions now ask for analysts who can “own and establish KPIs.” Why? Because employers need you to translate available data into business performance.

THE DISCONNECT:

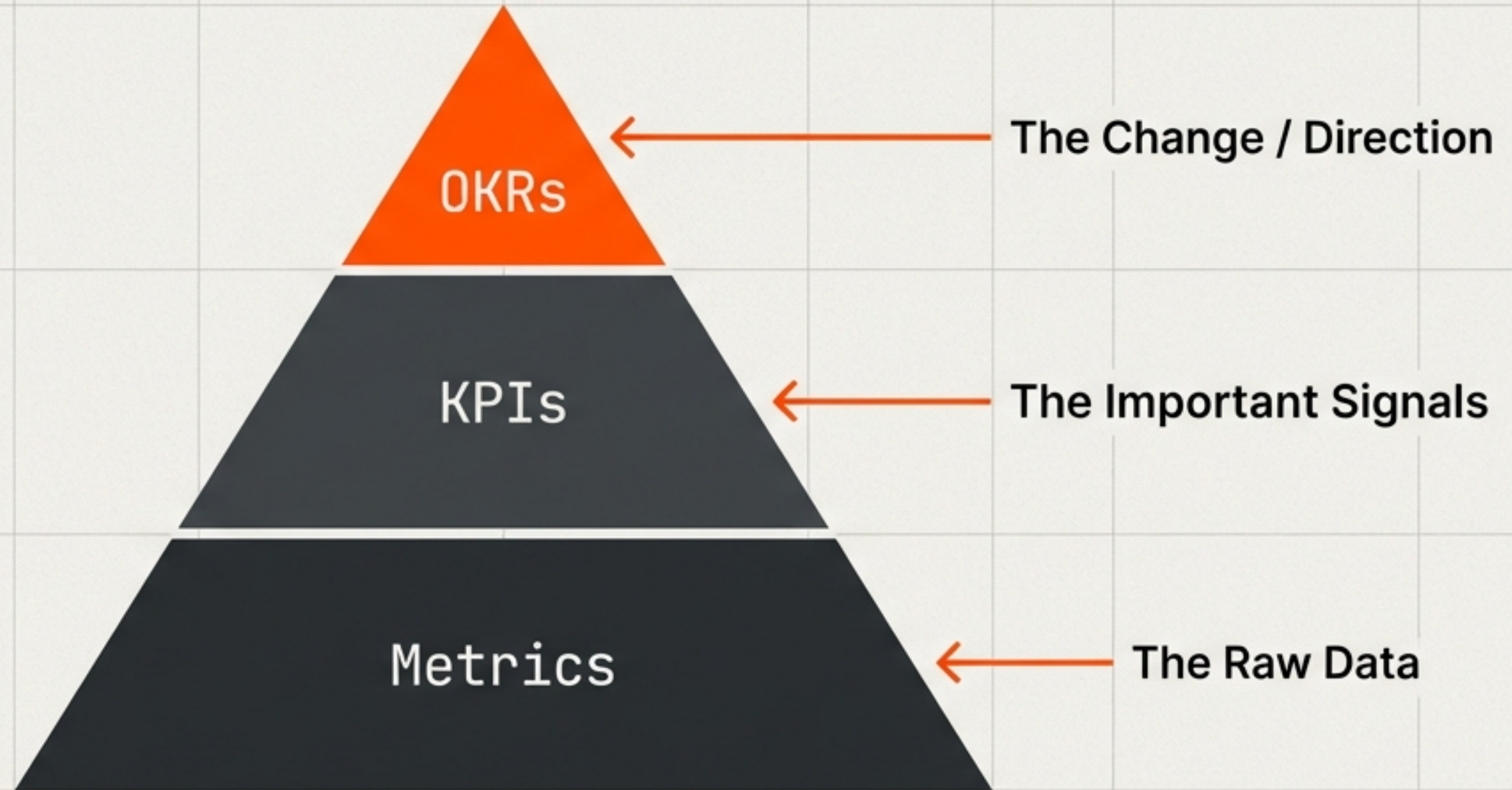
✗ The Trap: Focusing solely on cleaning data and building dashboards.

! The Requirement: Speaking the language of the business—Goals, Stakeholders, and Strategy.

➔ The Goal: Help leadership make sense of values, surface important numbers, and determine if the company is winning or losing.



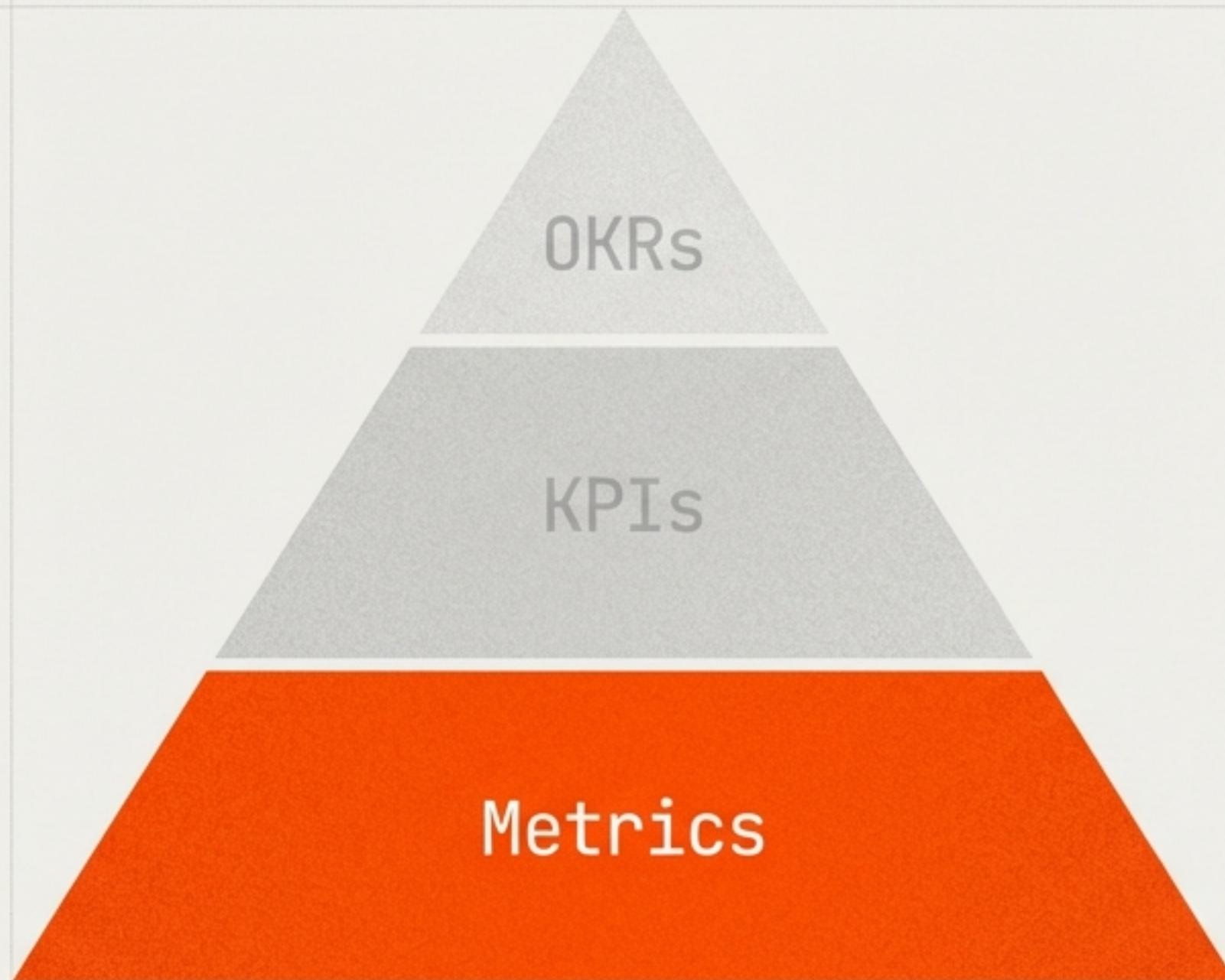
Not all numbers are created equal. We organize them by altitude and impact.



This framework organizes the landscape of data from
"everything available" to "what actually matters."

The Foundation: Metrics

Metrics are simply quantitative values that live in the data.



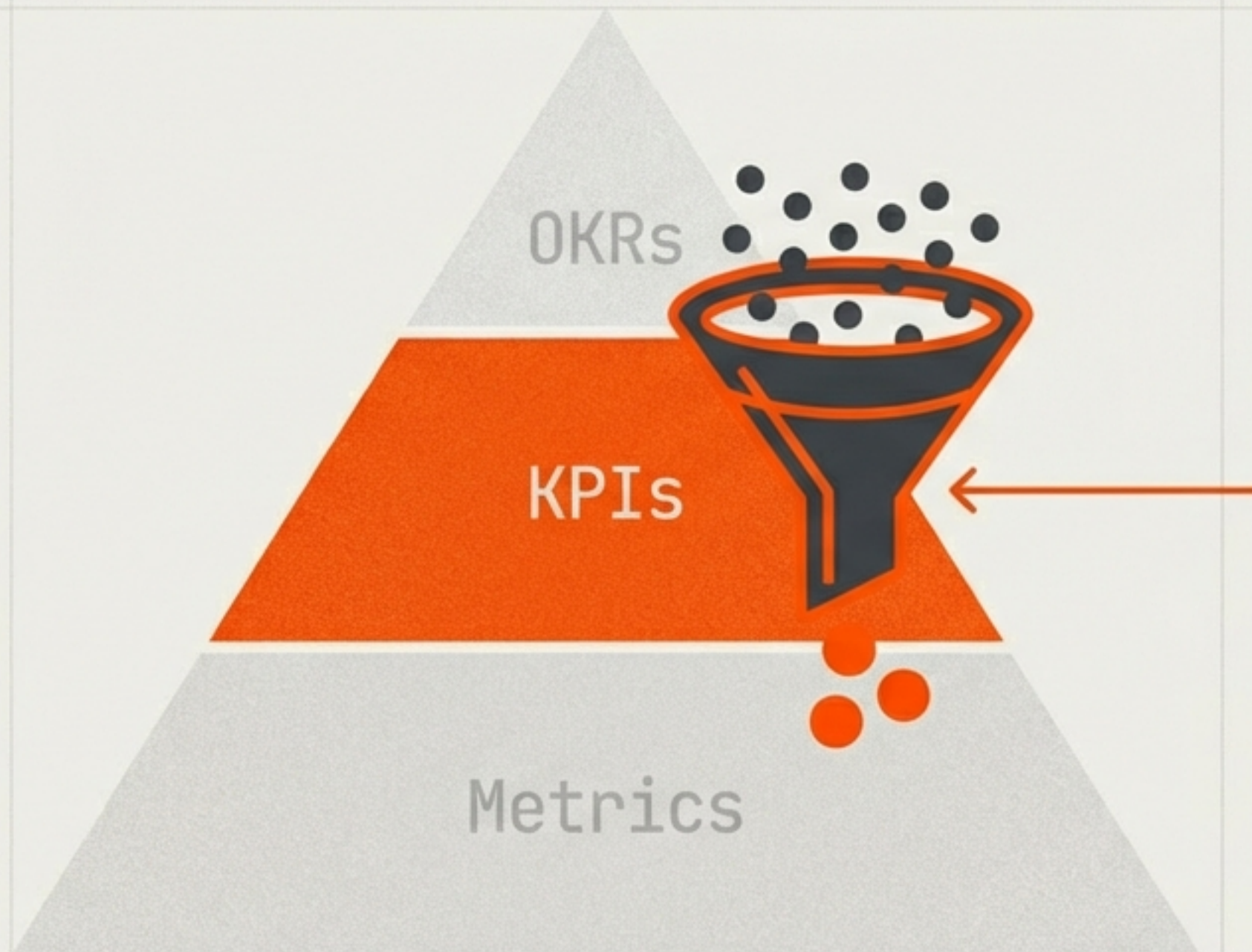
DEFINITION: Anything that can be tracked. At this stage, we haven't decided if they are relevant to performance. Just because you can track it doesn't mean you should report it.

CASE STUDY: YOUTUBE CHANNEL ANALYSIS

- Views, Likes, Comments
- Subscriber Count
- Video Length, Impressions
- 2x Speed Usage (A metric that exists, but may not be important)

The Filter: KPIs (Key Performance Indicators)

The 3-5 metrics that tell us if we are winning or losing.



SELECTION CRITERIA:

1. Influence: Can we actually change this number?
2. Performance: Does this genuinely reflect health/success?

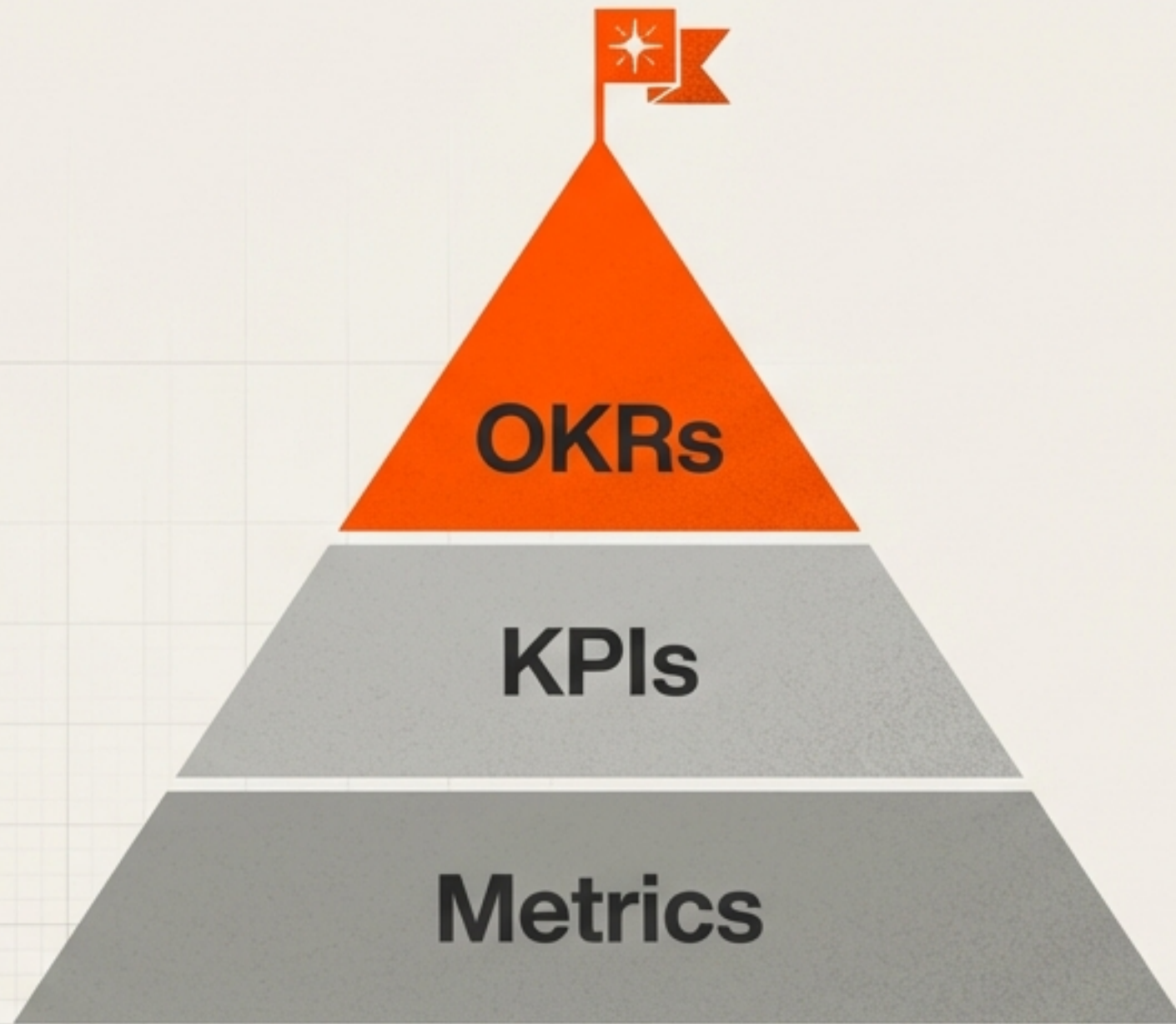
CASE STUDY: YOUTUBE CHANNEL ANALYSIS

From 100 metrics, we select only 3:

1. Average View Duration (Critical for algorithm ranking)
2. Click-Through Rate (Measures thumbnail effectiveness)
3. New Subscribers (Measures genuine interest)

The North Star: OKRs (Objectives and Key Results)

OKRs define the strategic change leadership wants to drive.



CONTEXT: Directional goals set by leadership. They signal “where we want to be by a certain date.”

HIERARCHY: Metrics support KPIs; KPIs support OKRs.

CASE STUDY: YOUTUBE CHANNEL ANALYSIS

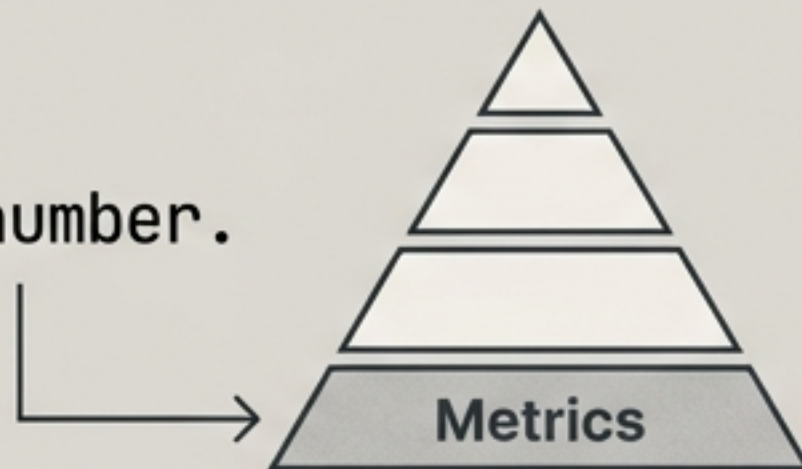
- “Hit 90k Subscribers by December.”
- “Increase Course Revenue by 30%.”
- “Decrease Churn by 5%.”

Don't just report the weather; explain the climate.

JUNIOR ANALYST (Stuck in the Metrics Layer)

Total page views were 47k.
Bounce rate was 2.3%.

Stops at the number.
No context.



SENIOR ANALYST (Climbing the Pyramid)

Our KPIs (Conversion and AOV)
are up 18%, which directly
drives our OKR of increasing
revenue by 30% this quarter.

Ties data points
to strategic
company goals.



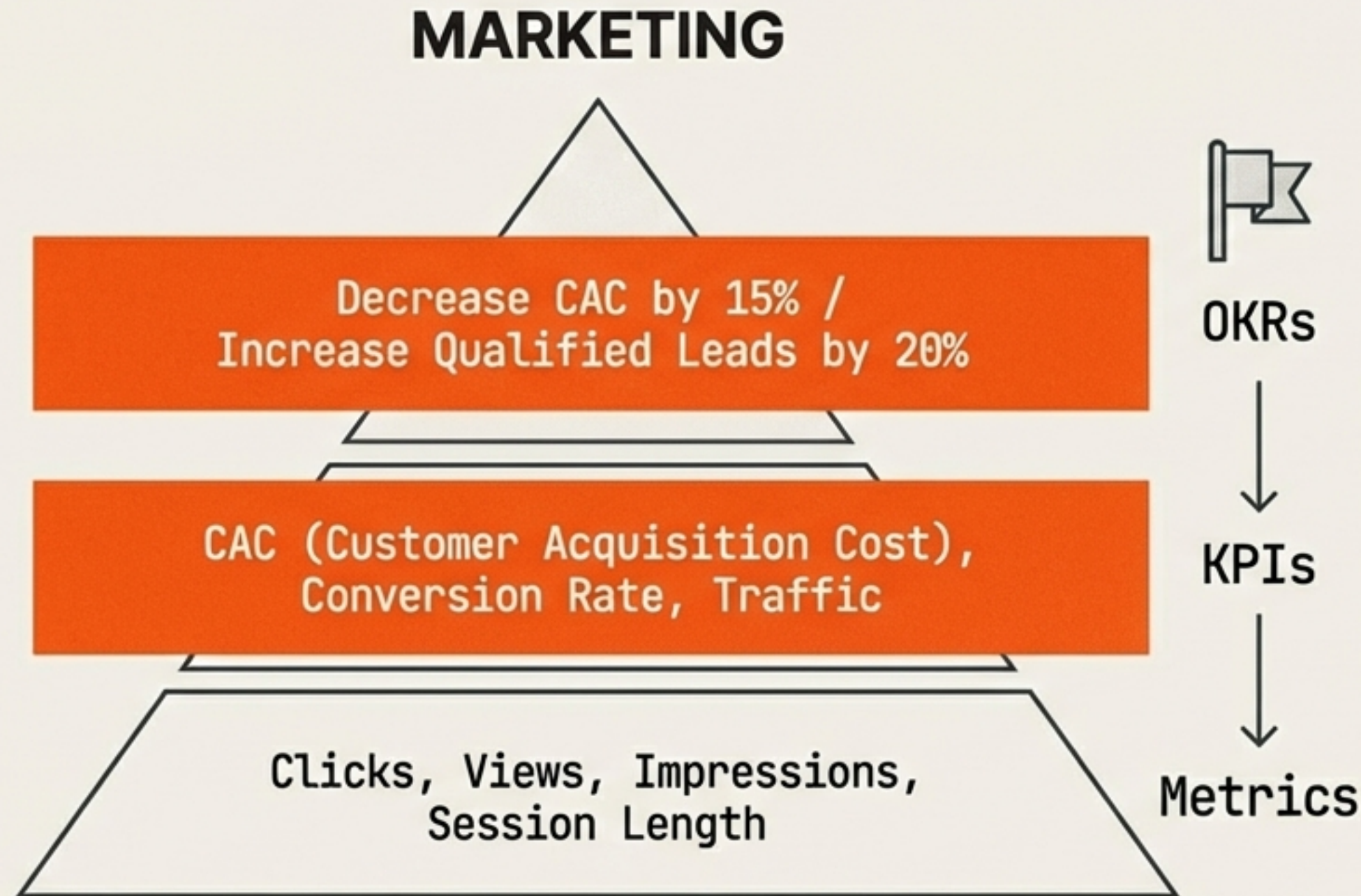
The Industry Cheat Code

You don't need to relearn the universe for every job application.

	Marketing	Finance	Operations	Product
SaaS Company				
Solar Company				
Socks Company				

INSIGHT: Metric pyramids are similar within departments across industries. If you understand the Marketing Pyramid for Tech, you largely understand it for Logistics.

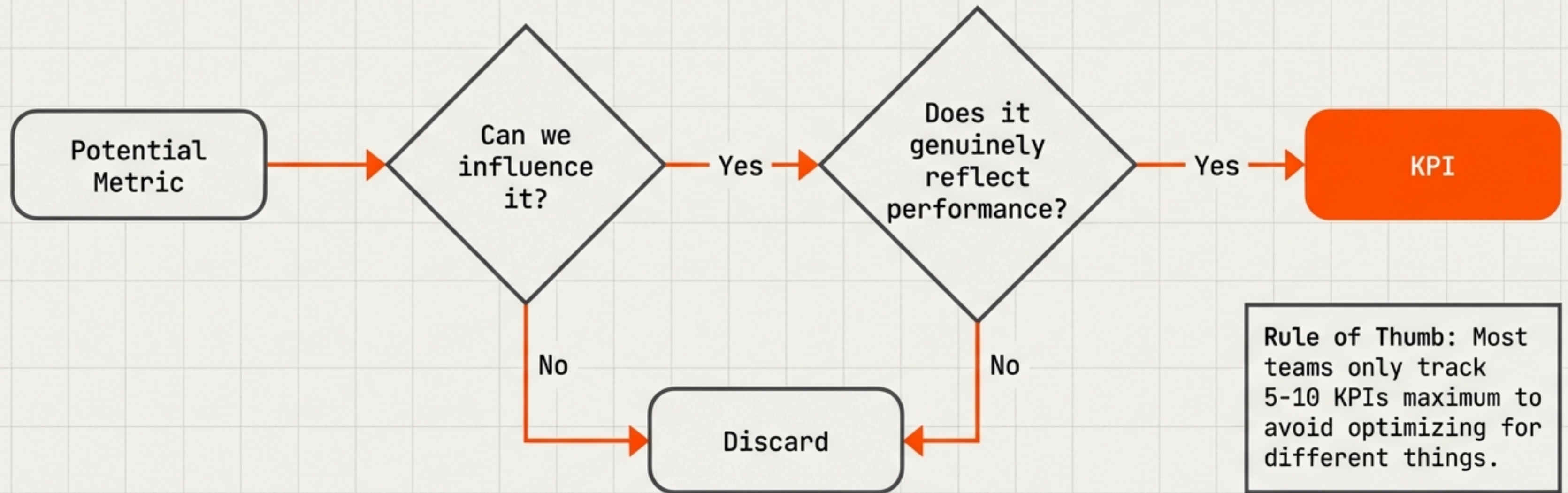
The product changes, but the function stays the same.



TAKEAWAY: An analyst moving from Fintech to E-commerce doesn't need to start from zero. They can immediately ask, "What is our current CAC?" and sound like an insider.

How to choose the right KPIs without guessing.

The Two-Question Filter



Based on lessons from Facebook analytics interviews.

Execution Step 1: Master the 'Top 10'

Go deep on the core metrics for your target role.

The Mastery Checklist



TECHNICAL []

What is the actual formula? How is it calculated in the database?



PLAIN ENGLISH []

Can you explain it to a non-technical stakeholder without jargon?



RELATIONAL []

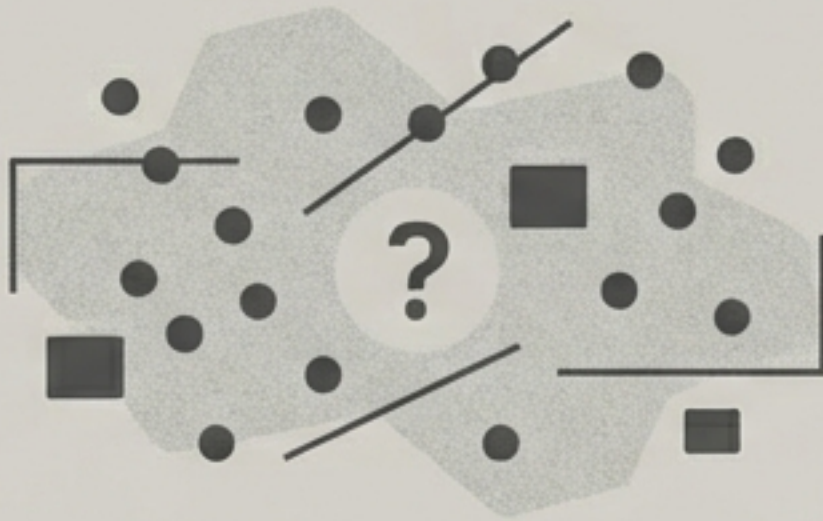
Which teams care about this, and how does it affect their goals?

This preparation makes you sound like you've already worked in the industry.

Execution Step 2: Build a Better Portfolio

Pick datasets that map to real business functions.

The Mistake



Using random datasets without context.
No clear business owner.

The Pro Move

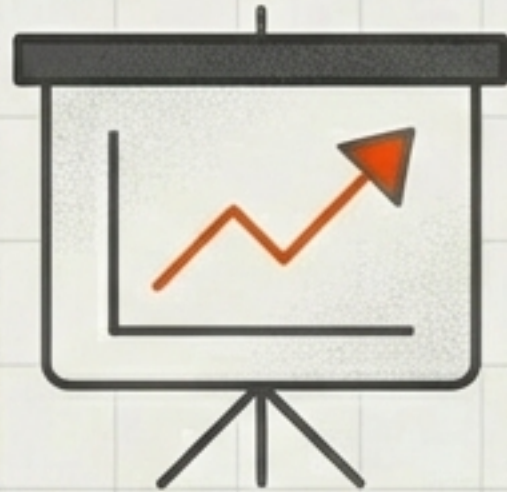


Define your KPIs upfront. Explicitly state:
"For this analysis, we focused on Total Sales and Refunds because they tie to the revenue OKR."

Tip: Revenue, Marketing, Customer, and Usage metrics are the most versatile categories.

Execution Step 3: Study the Leaders

Immerse yourself in high-level business communication.



Investor Decks

See how they visually present growth and strategy.



Earnings Reports

Read the text they use to describe success and failure.



Earnings Calls

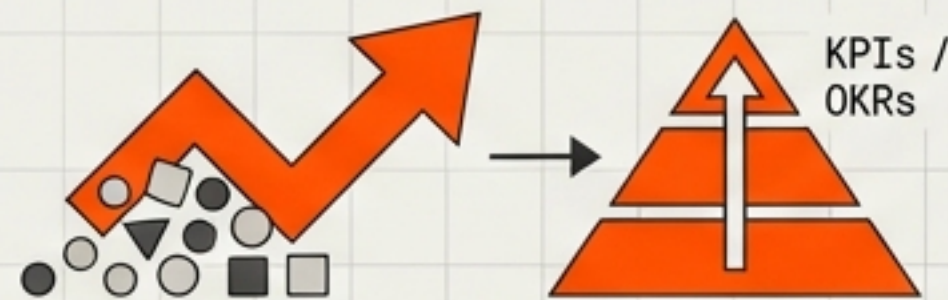
Listen to the Q&A to hear how they defend their numbers.

Tip: Pay attention to the specific verbs and adjectives used by C-suite executives in their communication.

The Roadmap to the Top 1%

01. Move up the Pyramid

Stop listing Metrics. Connect them to KPIs and OKRs.



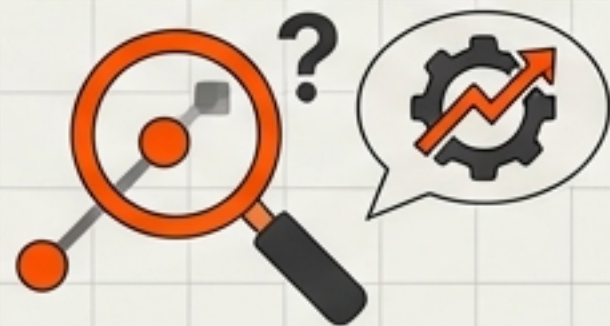
02. Learn Department Pyramids

Master the universal metrics for Marketing, Sales, or Finance to unlock any industry.



03. Contextualize

Never present a number without explaining why it matters to the business goal.



04. Define Upfront

In interviews and projects, explicitly state which KPIs you chose and why.



Chosen KPIs: [Sales, Refunds],
Reason: [Tie to Revenue OKR]

Your job isn't just to find numbers; it's to find meaning.

**The best analysts help
teams see whether they are
winning or losing.**

NEXT STEPS

Download the
Business Metrics
Cheat Sheet



NEXT STEPS

Check out the
Analytics Accelerator
Mentorship Program

